E-CELL IIT BOMBAY | NEC 2026

Launchpad

FLAGSHIP EVENT SUBMISSION

From first idea to first venture.

Central University of Andhra Pradesh

CUAP E-Cell

NEC ID	NEC2644385	**Team Name**	1%
College	Central University of Andhra Pradesh, Anantapur	**Organising Club**	CUAP E-Cell
Flagship Event	Launchpad	**Mode**	Offline
Phase 1	Freshers to Founders	**Phase 1 Date**	16 October 2026
Phase 1 Venue	Rooms 8 & 9, APJ Kalam Block	**Phase 1 Time**	2:30 PM to 4:00 PM

1. Event Brochure

Launchpad is a three-phase journey that takes a first-year student from "What is entrepreneurship?" to pitching a real idea, run by CUAP E-Cell at Central University of Andhra Pradesh.

Objectives

- Introduce freshers to entrepreneurship and to CUAP E-Cell in their first term.
- Give every participant a hands-on experience: brainstorming, pitching and quizzing.
- Build an idea pipeline and recruit new E-Cell members.
- Create social media content that carries the E-Cell's message beyond campus.

Who it is for: first-year students of all departments. No business background or start up idea is needed.

The three phases

Phases 2 and 3 are proposed; their dates are tentative.

Phase	Event	Date	What happens
1	Freshers to Founders	16 Oct 2026	Intro session with five activities (below)
2	Build Week	Nov 2026 (tentative)	Idea-to-start up workshops, mentoring, team formation
3	Launchpad Pitch Finale	Dec 2026 (tentative)	Teams pitch to a panel of founders, faculty and mentors

Phase 1: Freshers to Founders

16 October 2026, 2:30 to 4:00 PM, Rooms 8 & 9, APJ Kalam Block, CUAP. Tagline: Your journey into entrepreneurship starts here!

Time	Activity	What happens
2:30 to 2:35	Opening	Anchors welcome freshers and faculty and set up the session
2:35 to 3:00	Meet Your E-Cell	PPT on CUAP E-Cell: vision, departments, activities, competitions, membership. Team introductions
3:00 to 3:15	Freshers Unfiltered	Fun entrepreneurship questions put to freshers, recorded for social media
3:15 to 3:35	Idea Storm: The 10-Minute Start-up Challenge	Teams get a problem, brainstorm for 10 minutes, then give 60-second pitches
3:35 to 3:50	Start-up Quiz	Scored quiz on start up and entrepreneurs; winners announced
3:50 to 4:00	Idea Wall and close	Freshers post ideas on the wall, vote, and sign up for E-Cell

Time split is proposed.

Guests: a faculty member from the university (for the welcome and prizes) and the E-Cell team. For Phases 2 and 3: local founders, alumni entrepreneurs and incubator mentors (see section 3).

Brochure: the full brochure is in the design file linked under section 5.

2. Event Theme & Tagline

Name: Launchpad

Tagline: *From first idea to first venture.*

Why this name. A launchpad is where a rocket starts, not where it ends. That matches freshers: they arrive with curiosity and no experience, and the event gives them the first push. It also fits the rocket-and-bulb imagery in the NEC 2026 logo.

Why this tagline. It states the journey in six words and makes the promise concrete: an idea first, then a venture. It also tells freshers they can start with an idea alone.

Theme: *Start small, start now.* Every phase asks participants to do something, not just listen.

Visual identity. We carry forward the Freshers to Founders poster: torn-paper textures, bold stencil headlines, and a purple, yellow and blue palette with orange bursts. The CUAP E-Cell, CUAP and NEC 2026 logos sit at the top of every creative.

3. Guest & Speaker Outreach Plan

We start six weeks before each phase and work through four steps: identify, invite, follow up, coordinate.

1. Identify (6 weeks out)

Build a list of 15 names for every 3 slots we need, from these groups:

Group	Examples	Why
University	Faculty, deans, alumni cell	Easy to reach; gives credibility
Alumni founders	CUAP graduates running ventures	Relatable story for freshers
Local ecosystem	Anantapur and Andhra Pradesh founders, MSME owners	Low travel cost
Incubators and networks	Start-up incubators, E-Cells of other colleges	Mentors and referrals
Online	Founders who speak virtually	Fallback and hybrid slot

2. Invite (5 weeks out)

Send a personal email or message, not a bulk one. Draft:

> **Subject: Invitation to speak at Launchpad, CUAP E-Cell**
>
> Dear [Name],
>
> I am [Your name] from the Entrepreneurship Cell of Central University of Andhra Pradesh. We are running Launchpad, a three-phase programme for first-year students that takes them from their first idea to a pitch.
>
> Your work on [specific thing they did] is exactly the journey we want our students to see. We would be honoured if you could join us as [speaker / mentor / judge] on [date] for about [20 minutes / 2 hours].
>
> What we offer: an engaged audience of [number] students, travel and hospitality support, and recognition on our posters and social media.
>
> Could we have a short call this week to share details? A one-page brief is attached.
>
> Warm regards,
> [Name, role, phone, E-Cell email]

3. Follow up

- Day 4 after the invite: a short reminder message.
- Day 10: a second reminder through a different channel (WhatsApp or phone).
- Day 14 with no reply: move to the next name on the list.

4. Coordinate after they say yes

- Send a confirmation with date, venue, slot length and topic within 24 hours.
- Collect a bio, photo and logo for the poster 3 weeks out.
- Assign one E-Cell member as the single point of contact for each guest.
- Confirm again 7 days and 1 day before, and arrange transport and a welcome on the day.
- Send a thank-you note and a photo within 48 hours after the event.

4. Event Budget

The three phases of Launchpad cost an estimated ₹84,700 in total, including a 10% contingency. All figures are planning estimates in INR; replace them with real quotes as they come in.

Assumptions

- Free entry. Phase 1 has about 150 attendees, Phase 2 about 100 and Phase 3 about 150.
- All venues are university rooms or halls, so there is no rent.
- Two to three guests per phase, mostly local, with one outstation guest at the finale.

Category	Basis	Amount (₹)
Venue	University rooms and hall, no rent	0
Production and AV	Sound system, extra mics and projector hire for the finale	6,000
Branding	Banners, standees, backdrop, printed posters	8,000
Hospitality	Refreshments (150 × ₹40, 100 × ₹40, 150 × ₹60 = ₹19,000) plus guest travel and mementos (₹8,000)	27,000
Marketing	Flyers, ambassador kits, boosted posts	7,000
Logistics	Idea Wall board, sticky notes, stationery, local transport	5,000
Technology	Design tool subscription, video editing, internet	3,000
Prizes	₹3,000 for Phase 1 winners, ₹15,000 for the finale	18,000
Certificates	Printing for participants and volunteers	3,000
Subtotal		**77,000**
Contingency	10% of subtotal	7,700
Total		**84,700**

Funding plan

Source	How we get it	Target (₹)
University support	Request to the dean and student affairs office	25,000
Local sponsors	Title and associate sponsor packages, offered to local businesses, banks and coaching centres	35,000
In-kind partners	Printing, refreshments and prizes donated by partners	15,000
E-Cell funds	Existing funds and merchandise sales	9,700
Total		**84,700**

Sponsor benefits. Logo on posters and banners, a mention on social media, a stall or a 2-minute talk at the finale, and access to the student audience.

Cost control. Pay vendors only against written quotes and keep a live expense sheet. Spend the contingency only with the treasurer's approval.

5. Posters & Creatives

Every creative follows one visual identity, taken from the Freshers to Founders poster.

Style guide

- **Look:** torn-paper layers, halftone photos, stencil headlines.
- **Colours:** purple, yellow and blue, with orange bursts and a black and off-white base.
- **Logos:** CUAP E-Cell, CUAP and NEC 2026, always at the top, in round frames.
- **Info strip:** date, venue and time at the bottom of every poster.

Creatives to produce

Creative	Use	When
Launchpad master poster	Notice boards, WhatsApp groups	3 weeks before Phase 1
Freshers to Founders poster	Phase 1 promotion. 16 Oct 2026, 2:30 to 4:00 PM, Rooms 8 & 9, APJ Kalam Block	10 days before
Countdown stories (5)	Instagram stories	Last 5 days
Activity teasers (5)	One card each for Meet Your E-Cell, Freshers Unfiltered, Idea Storm, Start-up Quiz, Idea Wall	Week before
Guest announcement cards	One per confirmed guest	As confirmed
Registration QR flyer	Hostels, canteen, classrooms	2 weeks before
Certificate and banner templates	Event day	Event day

Design files

Poster (A4) and brochure (continuous A4 plus an earlier trifold version): Launchpad Poster and Brochure

6. Publicity Strategy

Our audience is first-year students living on campus, so we reach them where they already are: hostels, classrooms and WhatsApp groups. Publicity runs for three weeks before each phase.

Channel	How we use it	Why	When
WhatsApp groups	Share the poster and registration link in batch and hostel groups	The main channel students check daily	Week 3 and the last 3 days
Instagram	Teasers, countdown stories, reels from past sessions	Visual, and shareable by students	Week 2 to event day
Class visits	A 2-minute pitch by an E-Cell member at the start of a class, with faculty permission	Personal and reaches students who skip social media	Week 2
Batch ambassadors	One first-year per department who shares updates and collects sign-ups	Peer trust	From week 3
Faculty and department heads	Ask them to announce in class	Adds weight for freshers	Week 2
Posters and standees	Notice boards, canteen, library, hostels	Catches walking traffic	Week 2
Email	Invitation to registered students and faculty with the agenda	Formal reminder	1 week and 1 day before
Partner E-Cells and clubs	Cross-posting and shared audience	Extends reach beyond our own network	Week 2
Social media content	Freshers Unfiltered videos posted after Phase 1	Promotes Phase 2 using real student voices	Right after Phase 1

Innovative touches

- **Idea Wall teaser:** a blank wall in the canteen where students write "What problem should someone solve?" before the event.
- **Bring a friend:** one fresher who brings a friend gets an early-entry slot.

Tracking. Every channel gets its own QR code or form link, so we can see which ones bring registrations.

7. Audience Estimation

We expect about 150 attendees at Freshers to Founders, in a range of 97 to 216, and we update the number weekly as registrations come in.

Method. Start from the size of the target group, then apply a conversion rate at each step from awareness to attendance:

$$\text{Attendance} = N \times \text{reach rate} \times \text{registration rate} \times \text{show-up rate} \times (1 + w)$$

N is the first-year strength; w is the walk-in share on top of registered attendees.

Step	Rate	Basis	Expected
First-year students (N)		Assumed 500; replace with the admissions office figure	500
Reached by publicity	90%	Class visits, WhatsApp groups and hostels cover most of the batch	450
Register	40%	Typical for free campus events; check against past E-Cell sign-ups	180
Show up	70%	Free events lose about 30% of registrants	126
Walk-ins	+20%	Students who join after seeing the event live	151

Range. Low case (30% register, 60% show up): about 97. High case (50% register, 80% show up): about 216.

Inputs we refine with

- Registration count, tracked daily from each channel's QR code or form link.
- Past E-Cell event turnout, if records exist.
- Class-visit sign-up counts and ambassador estimates.
- Venue capacity: confirm the seating of Rooms 8 & 9 and plan for the high case.

Decision points. At 7 days out, compare registrations to the plan. If registrations are under 50% of the target, add another round of class visits. If they are over, confirm the larger room or a second session.

8. Venue Plan

We pick venues on campus first, because it keeps costs at zero and freshers already know the way. The process takes about two weeks and runs in five steps.

1. **Define needs.** Capacity for the high-case audience, a projector and sound system, power points, seating that works for group activities, and a time slot that does not clash with classes.
2. **Shortlist 3 options.** For example Rooms 8 & 9 in the APJ Kalam Block, a seminar hall and an open-air space, for each phase.
3. **Visit and score.** Visit each at the planned time and score it on the criteria below.
4. **Get permissions.** Submit a written request to the dean or registrar, copy the faculty coordinator, and request any extra hours for setup.

5. **Confirm in writing.** Get the booking approved by email, do a tech check 2 days before, and keep a backup venue on hold.

Criterion	What we check	Weight
Capacity	Seats vs. high-case audience	25%
Location and access	Distance from hostels and classrooms; accessibility for all students	20%
Infrastructure	Projector, mics, power, Wi-Fi, lighting, ventilation	20%
Cost	Rent and extra charges	15%
Availability	Free for setup and the event slot	10%
Permissions	Time and effort to get approval	10%

Current choice for Phase 1: Rooms 8 & 9, APJ Kalam Block, on 16 Oct 2026, 2:30 to 4:00 PM. The finale will need a larger hall or auditorium, which we will shortlist by Nov 2026.

9. Risk & Contingency Plan

Every risk has an owner and a trigger, so the team acts instead of debating on the day.

Risk	Early signal	Contingency	Owner
Low attendance	Registrations under 50% of target 7 days out	Extra class visits, faculty announcements, a reminder blast, and a smaller room so it still feels full	Marketing lead
Unexpectedly high attendance	Registrations above the high case	Move to a larger hall, run two batches, or stream to a second room	Logistics lead
Key speaker cancels	No confirmation 7 days out, or a cancellation message	Keep a ranked backup list; ask the backup guest 5 days ahead; or use a recorded talk or alumni video call	Outreach lead
Budget overrun	Spend above 90% of a category	Cut non-essentials first, use in-kind support, and approve contingency spend with the treasurer	Treasurer
Venue or logistics issue	Booking unconfirmed 3 days out; power or AC failure	Backup room on hold; a portable speaker and power strips on site	Logistics lead
Technical failure (online or hybrid)	Failed tech check; bad internet	Test 2 days before, a second laptop, a mobile hotspot, a recorded backup of the talk, and a co-host managing chat	Tech lead
Schedule delay	A session runs over by 5 minutes	A timekeeper with cue cards; shorten the Quiz and Idea Wall first; keep the E-Cell intro and IdeaStorm intact	Event coordinator
Missing essential resources	Checklist items not ticked 24 hours before	Printed checklist per team; spare mics, markers and sticky notes; borrow from other clubs	Logistics lead

Day-of protocol. A coordinator holds a one-page run sheet with the schedule, contact numbers and backups. The team meets 60 minutes before the start for a final check.

10. Post-Event Evaluation

We judge success against targets set before the event, and publish a one-page report within 7 days.

Area	Metric	How we measure	Target
Attendance	Registered vs. attended; walk-ins	Sign-in sheet or QR scan	150 attended
Engagement	Teams that pitched; quiz participants; ideas posted on the Idea Wall	Count on the day	15 teams; 60 ideas
Participant feedback	Average rating and written comments	5-question form at the exit (rating out of 5, best part, improvement, interest in joining)	4.0 or above out of 5
Recruitment	New E-Cell sign-ups	Membership form	40 sign-ups
Outreach	Reach and views of posts, reels and Freshers Unfiltered videos	Instagram insights	5,000 reach
Finance	Spend vs. budget by category	Expense sheet	At or below ₹84,700
Speaker and partner satisfaction	Feedback call or form; willingness to return	Short form 48 hours after	80% say yes
Pipeline	Ideas moving into Phase 2	Count of teams signing up for Build Week	20 teams

Process

1. Collect feedback at the exit before people leave.
2. Hold a 30-minute team debrief within 48 hours: what worked, what did not, what we change.
3. Send thank-you notes and certificates to guests, volunteers and winners.
4. Share the one-page report with the university and sponsors, with photos and numbers.
5. Carry the lessons into Phase 2.

11. The links to the documents

1. Launchpad Poster and Brochure (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1C3vt3xFMiyntWxDOr3k9_fzgVcyEg-Ai/view?usp=drive_link)
2. UNIVERSITY BANNER (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1MZHlgyfwcMR6oPYyiWOz_3q_RWKacfDl/view?usp=sharing)